

Firearms Trace Data: New Mexico - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Contents

1. [ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer](#)
2. Table: [Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in New Mexico in Calendar Year 2023](#)
3. Table: [Firearm Types with a New Mexico Recovery](#)
4. Table: [Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a New Mexico Recovery](#)
5. Table: [Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a New Mexico Recovery](#)
6. Table: [Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery](#)
7. Table: [Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery](#)
8. Table: [Age of Possessors for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery](#)
9. Table: [Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery](#)
10. [Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics](#)

ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in New Mexico in Calendar Year 2023

4,847

Firearm Types with a New Mexico Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	3,161
Rifles	710
Revolvers	417
Shotguns	336
Receivers/Frames	100
Machineguns	46
Machinegun Conversion Devices	36
Derringers	29
Other*	12

* Other includes Silencers, Unknown Types, an Any Other Weapon and a Combination.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a New Mexico Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	1,865
.22 Cal	483
.40 Cal	353

.45 Cal	330
12GA	260
.380 Cal	241
5.56mm	163
.38 Cal	159
MULTI	152
7.62mm	102

NOTE: There were 592 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 147 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a New Mexico Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Weapon Offense	1,935
Firearm Under Investigation	925
Possession of Weapon	673
Dangerous Drugs	257
Found Firearm	255
Aggravated Assault	174
Weapons Trafficking	145
Homicide	121
Traffic Offense	93
Suicide	50

NOTE: There were 219 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

New Mexico	2,905
Texas	254
Arizona	111
Colorado	77
California	30
Oklahoma	26
Nevada	21
Ohio	19
Florida	18
Illinois	18
Tennessee	17
Washington	16
Georgia	15
Missouri	15
Virginia	15

NOTE: An additional 32 states accounted for 209 other traces. The source state was identified in 3,766 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	320
3 Months to Under 7 Months	232
7 Months to Under 1 Year	252
1 Year to Under 2 Years	504
2 Years to Under 3 Years	451
3 Years and Over	1,978

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 New Mexico Average Time-to-Crime: **7.54 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	95
18 to 21	216
22 to 24	168
25 to 30	290
31 to 40	480
41 to 50	334
Over 50	434

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 New Mexico Average Age of Possessor: **37 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Albuquerque	2,665
Las Cruces	279
Roswell	269
Hobbs	192
Alamogordo	165
Farmington	147
Espanola	80
Gallup	80
Clovis	78
Santa Fe	66

NOTE: There were 108 additional municipalities that accounted for 818 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for eight traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of New Mexico. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to New Mexico.

- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a New Mexico Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a New Mexico Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a New Mexico Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024